

STRUCTURE AND PATTERNS OF SENTENCES, PHRASES, AND CLAUSES

PARTS OF A SENTENCE

- The **subject** of a sentence tells the reader who or what the sentence is about.
- The **verb** tells the reader what the action or state of the subject is.
- The **object** of a sentence tells the reader who or what is affected by the subject's action.

Subject

The man

Verb

opened

Object

the fridge.

A FINITE VERB

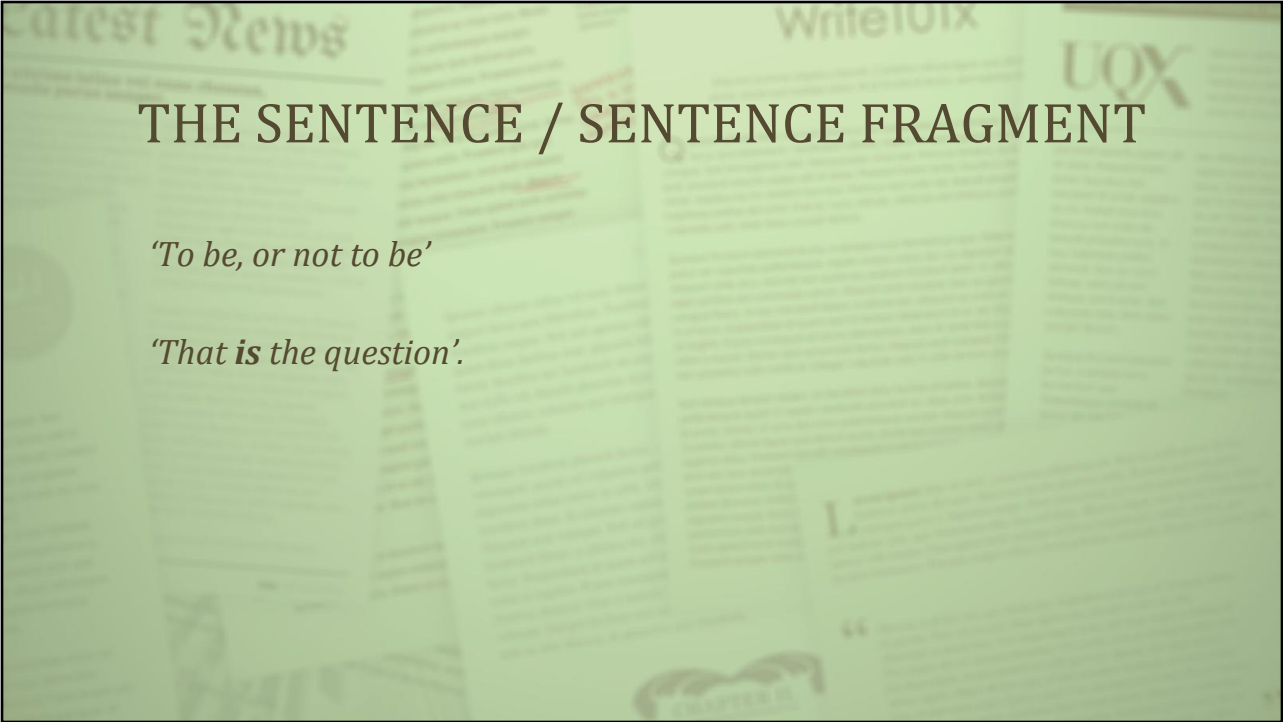
A finite verb is a verb that belongs to a subject and shows tense:

I did my homework.

AN INFINITIVE

An infinitive is made up of the marker 'to' and the main part of the verb.

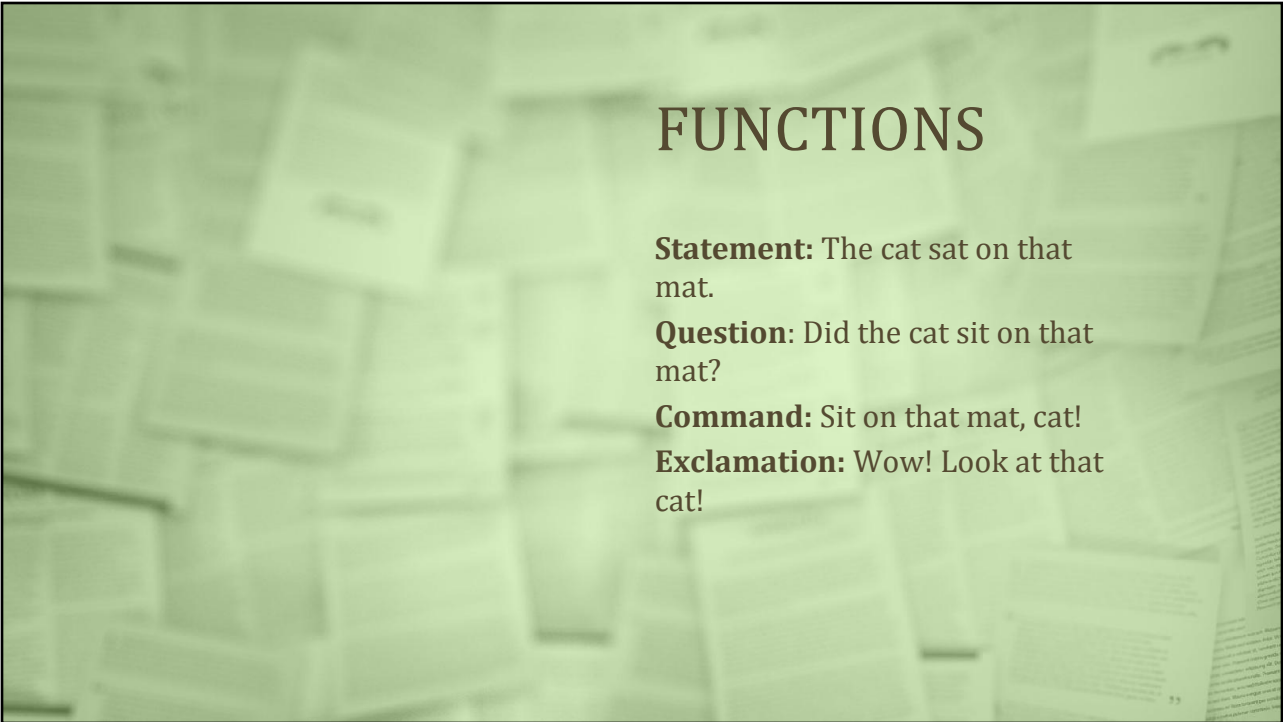
I love to read.



THE SENTENCE / SENTENCE FRAGMENT

'To be, or not to be'

*'That **is** the question'.*



FUNCTIONS

Statement: The cat sat on that mat.

Question: Did the cat sit on that mat?

Command: Sit on that mat, cat!

Exclamation: Wow! Look at that cat!

A CLAUSE

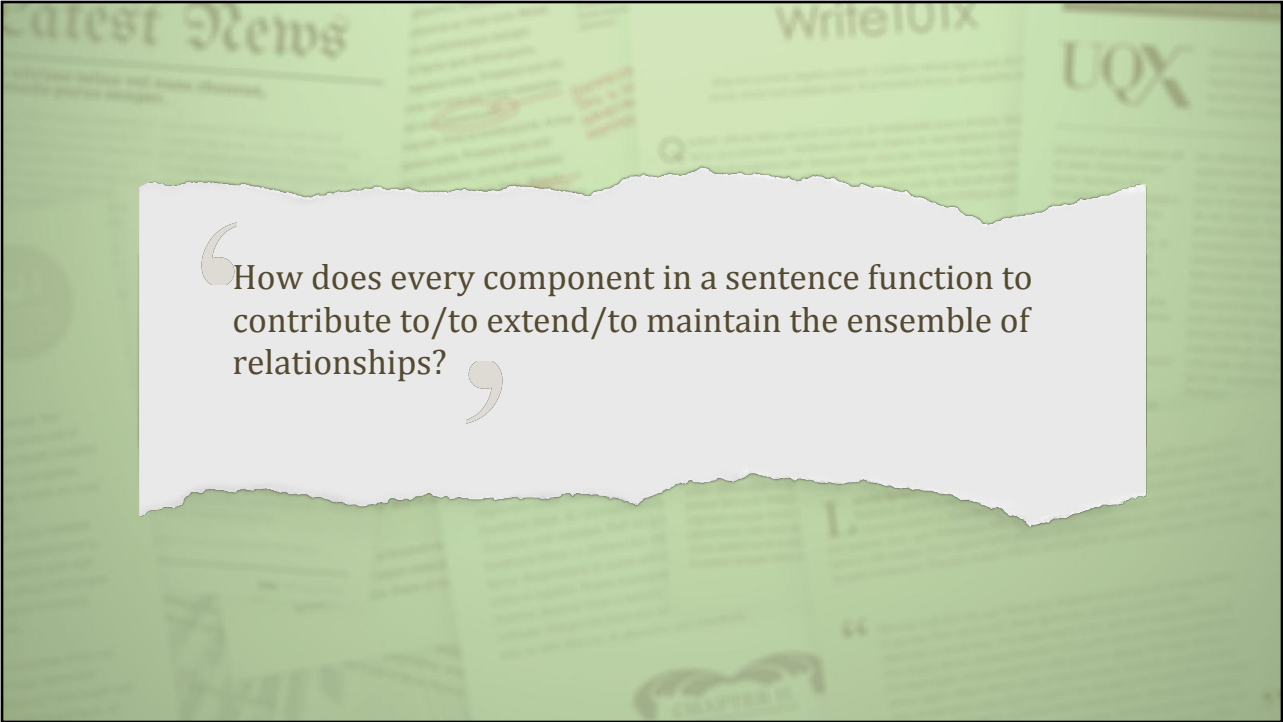
I love reading.

A dependent (subordinate) clause
does not make sense on its own.

Because I love reading

SENTENCE STRUCTURES / FORMS

1. Simple: one **independent** clause.
Sherlock Holmes waited.
2. Compound: two or more **independent** clauses.
 - a) Sherlock Holmes waited ; however, Watson delayed his visit.
 - b) Sherlock Holmes waited, and [he] was missed at Lloyd's registers.
3. Complex: one **dependent** clause subordinated to one **independent** clause, either at the beginning, in the middle, or at the end. [Left-branching LB, mid-branching, MB, and right-branching RB sentences.]
 - a) **While Watson moved the lamp,** Sherlock Holmes waited.
 - b) Sherlock Holmes, **though he was anxious to have his dinner,** waited.
 - c) Sherlock Holmes waited, **while Watson moved the lamp.**
4. Compound-complex: a second **independent** clause added to a complex sentence, or a **dependent** clause subordinated to a compound sentence.
 - a) **While Watson moved the lamp,** Sherlock Holmes waited, and [he] was missed at Lloyd's registers.
 - b) Sherlock Holmes waited, and [he] was missed at Lloyd's registers, **because he was a good customer.**



“How does every component in a sentence function to contribute to/to extend/to maintain the ensemble of relationships?”

CATEGORISING SENTENCES BY FORM

Loose (cumulative):

Plain language reforms have become law in many countries because law makers believe that citizens should have access to documents that they understand.

CATEGORISING SENTENCES BY FORM

Periodic:

Because law makers believe that citizens should have access to documents that they understand, **plain language reforms have become law in many countries.**

SUBJECTS, PREDICATES, AND OBJECTS

These are the 'slots' in a sentence.

The subject names. The predicate tells.

Subject	Predicate		
Sherlock Holmes	waited.		
John	gave	the cake	to her.
	Verb	Direct object	Indirect object



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